YOGA–A WAY OF LIFE

1 Yoga is a physical, mental, and spiritual practice that originated in ancient India.



2 The word 'Yoga' comes from the Sanskrit root 'yuj', which means 'to join' or 'to unite'.



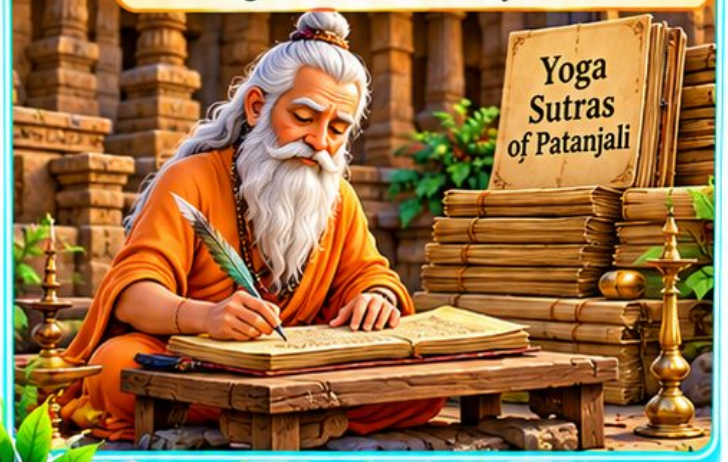
3 This symbolises the unity of mind and body; thought and action; harmony between human and nature.



4 It is a holistic approach to health and well-being.



5 Sage Patanjali presented the ancient tradition of yoga in a systematic way in 'Yoga Sutras of Patanjali'.



6 He described yoga as the means to make the mind quiet and free from all distractions.



YOGA–A WAY OF LIFE

1 Here are some of the benefits of yoga—



2 Yoga postures (*asanas*) help to stretch and strengthen the muscles,



3 increase flexibility, endurance and balance.



4 This can improve overall physical fitness.



5 This can also help to reduce body pains, such as lower back pain.





YOGA–A WAY OF LIFE

1 Yoga involves breathing techniques and meditation,



2 which can help to calm the mind and reduce stress and anxiety.



3 It relaxes the mind,



4 improves the quality of sleep



5 and increases concentration.



6



YOGA–A WAY OF LIFE

1 Yoga has been shown to boost the immune system.



2 It can improve heart health by lowering blood pressure and improving circulation.



3 Yoga can aid in weight loss by burning calories,



4 and maintaining health.



5 Yoga promotes a sense of overall well-being.



6 This is the reason why the benefits of practising yoga are internationally recognised.



YOGA–A WAY OF LIFE

1 The World Health Organisation (WHO) on 20th June 2021, launched an App called WHO mYoga.



2 The app contains a collection of videos and audio files to teach and support yoga practice.



3 The aim was to have an easy-to-use and free tool for people across the world to encourage them to practise yoga.



4 We can start practising yoga at any given moment of time.



5 We must remember that when we practise yoga *asanas* (postures), we do not just stretch the body. The mind has to be with the body.



6 This is the reason why it should be practised without distractions. If each stretch is coordinated with the breath and awareness, our practice will become a yogic practice.

